

The Heart of the Noble Infallible Lasso, of the Great Vehicle

Ārya-Amogha-pāśa-hṛdaya-mahāyāna-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 683 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དེའི་ཡོད་ཅན་པའི་སྒྲིབ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའི་གཟུངས།

Toh 683 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Amogha-pāśa-hṛdaya-mahāyāna-dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as the Phakpa Dönyö Shakpé Nyingpo, meaning "The Heart of the Noble Infallible Lasso of the Great Vehicle." It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur and centers on the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, whose emblematic attribute — the infallible lasso — symbolizes his power to rescue beings from suffering without fail. The text opens with a series of reverential homages to buddhas and bodhisattvas of the three times, to key figures such as Amitābha and Maitreya, and above all to Avalokiteśvara himself as the embodiment of great compassion, establishing a devotional frame for the dhāraṇī that follows. As a "heart" dhāraṇī, it distills the essence of a longer associated cycle and would have been used in ritual and contemplative practice within the Mahāyāna tradition.

In the language of India: Ārya-Amogha-pāśa-hṛdaya-mahāyāna-nāma-dhāraṇī.
In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Heart of the Noble Infallible Lasso, of the Great Vehicle."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas who have gone to, and who abide in, the three times. Homage to all the buddhas of the past, the future, and the present, and to all the noble śrāvakas. Homage to those who have gone perfectly and those who have entered perfectly. Homage to the great wise one, the son of Śāradvatī. Homage to the noble bodhisattvas beginning with noble Maitreya. Homage to the noble Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha Amitābha. Homage to the Three Jewels. Homage to the bodhisattva, the great being, the noble Avalokiteśvara, lord who is endowed with great compassion. Homage to the one who has attained great power.

Having paid homage to these, that which is spoken from the mouth of the noble Avalokiteśvara, lord, uttered in the presence of the Tathāgata in the midst of a vast assembly — called "The Heart of the Infallible Lasso" — I shall now proclaim. May all the words and all the aims of this mantra be accomplished. May I be protected from all fears.

Tadyathā: Oṃ cara cara, ciri ciri, curu curu, mara mara, miri miri, muru muru, mahākāruṇika, sara sara, siri siri, suru suru, curu curu, ciri ciri, biri biri, piri piri, miri miri, mahāpadmahasta, kala kala, kili kili, kulu kulu, mahāśuddhasattva, budhya budhya, bodha bodha, bodhi bodhi, bodhaya bodhaya, kaṇa kaṇa, kiṇi kiṇi, kuṇu kuṇu, paramaśuddhasattva, kara kara, kiri kiri, kuru kuru, mahāsthāmaprāpta, cala cala, sañcala sañcala, picala bicala, eṭṭa eṭṭa, bhara bhara, bhiri bhiri, bhuru bhuru, tara tara, tiri tiri, turu turu, ehyehi mahākāruṇika, mahāpaśupativedhadhara, dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, tara tara, sara sara, cara cara, para para, bara bara, mara mara, lara lara, hara hara, hā hā hi hī hu hū, oṃkara brahmavedhadhara, dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, tara tara, sara sara, cara cara, nara nara, bara bara, hara hara, raśmi śata sahasra pratimaṇḍita śarīraṃ, jvala jvala, tapa tapa, bhāsa bhāsa, bhrama bhrama, bhagavan soma, āditya, yama, varuṇa, kubera, brahmendrā, vāyu, agni, dhanda, deva, ṛṣigaṇa abhyarcita caraṇa, suru suru, curu curu, muru muru, ghuru ghuru, sanat Kumāra, rudra, vāsava, piṭṭhādhandā, vāyu, agni, ṛṣi, nāyaka, vināyaka bahuvidha vedhadhara, dhara dhara, dhiri dhiri, dhuru dhuru, tara tara, thara thara, ghara ghara, yara yara, lara lara, hara hara, para para, sara sara, bara bara, varadāyaka, samanta avalokita, bilokita, lokaśvara, maheśvara, tribhuvaneśvara, sarvagaṇa sam alaṃkṛta, avalokiteśvara, muhu muhu, muru muru, muya muya, muñca muñca, śīghraṃ śīghraṃ.

May I be protected from all fears, all demonic interferences, all harms, all contagious illnesses, all disturbances, all poisons, and all diseases. Protect, protect! And likewise may there be complete liberation from killing, binding, beating, abuse, kings, fire, water, poison, and weapons.

Kaṇa kaṇa, kiṇi kiṇi, kuṇu kuṇu, cara cara, ciri ciri, curu curu, indriya, bala.

boddhyaṃga. Catur-ārya-satya-samprakāśaka. Tapa tapa, tama tama, dama dama, sama sam, dhama dhama. Mahākāruṇika. Mahātamas. Andhakāra-vidhhamana. Ṣaṭ-pāramitā-paripūraka. Mala mala, mili mili, mulu mulu. Ṭa ṭa ṭa ṭa, ṭha ṭha ṭha ṭha, ṭi ṭi ṭi ṭi, ṭu ṭu ṭu ṭu, ṭhi ṭhi ṭhi ṭhi, ṭhu ṭhu ṭhu ṭhu. Eṇeyacarmakṛta-parikara. Ehy ehi mahākāruṇika. Īśvara. Maheśvara. Mahābhūtagaṇa-sambhañjaka. Kara kara, kiri kiri, kuru kuru, para para, hara hara, bara bara, sara sara, kara kara, kaṭa kaṭa, kiṭi kiṭi, kuṭu kuṭu, maṭa maṭa. Mahāviśuddha-viśaya-nivāsina. Mahākāruṇika-śvetayajñe-upapīta. Ratna-mukuta. Māyādhara. Sarvajña-śirasi-kṛta-jaṭā-mukuta. Mahāadbhuta. Kamala-alaṃkṛta-karatala. Dhyāna. Samādhi. Vimokṣa. Aprakampya. Bahu-sattva-santati-paripācaka. Mahākāruṇika

sarvakarma-āvaraṇa-viśodhaka.

Sarvajña-jñāna-paripūraka.

Sarva-vyādhi-parimocaka.

Sarvasattva-āśā-paripūraka.

Sarvasattva-samāśvāsana-karaṇa. Namastu te svāhā. Amoghāya svāhā. Amogha-pāśāya svāhā. Ajitāya svāhā. Aparājitāya svāhā. Amitābhāya svāhā. Amitābhasutāya svāhā. Māra-sainya-pramardanāya svāhā. Abhayāya svāhā. Abhaya-pradāya svāhā. Jayāya svāhā. Vijayāya svāhā. Jaya-vijayāya svāhā. Varadāya svāhā. Vara-pradāya svāhā. Akāla-mṛtyu-praśamanāya svāhā. Iḍaṃ me karma kuru namastu te svāhā. Oṃ raṇa raṇa hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ jaya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ jra jriṃ ju hūṃ svāhā. Oṃ hūṃ jaya svāhā. Oṃ hrīḥ trailokya-vijaya amogha-pāśa apratihata hrīḥ haḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

The ritual application of this dhāraṇī is as follows. By reciting it over the dhāraṇī vase of Amogha-pāśa, one may confer benefit upon those who have been seized by malevolent obstructors, those who have been taken hold of by spirits and demons, those who have fallen under the power of harmful spells, women who miscarry and have no children, and those whose children do not survive, and so forth. In order to perform this ritual, one should take a maṇḍala at the center of a riverbank, the foot of a solitary tree, a crossroads, an empty house, or a similar place. The maṇḍala is square, with four gateways, and one opening — either to the west or to the north. It is drawn with a single white pigment. In the center, draw a white lotus with eight petals. Then take a vase of gold, silver, or copper — one that is uncracked, undamaged, or alternatively a clay vase with the neck sealed with a strip of black leather and having no cracks or flaws — and fill it with scented water. Into it pour five kinds of precious substances, five kinds of medicines, and five kinds of grain. Bind the neck with a strip of white silk whose edge has not been cut, and with a garland of flowers. Insert into its mouth a branch of birch or sandalwood adorned with flowers and fruits, and place the vase upon the lotus. The one who recites the dhāraṇī should visualize himself as the body of the noble Avalokiteśvara. He should then visualize that vase as a jeweled pond filled with nectarous water, and from within that water imagine a white lotus arising. Upon that lotus he should visualize the seed syllable of the noble Avalokiteśvara as a white letter, and from that letter he should visualize the arising of the noble Avalokiteśvara himself. He should then make offerings and praises, and supplicate with the words: "May whatever I am accomplishing now be fulfilled." He should then recite the Amogha-pāśa dhāraṇī over the vase thirteen times without speaking any other words in between. If the water from that vase is then poured over the crown of the person's head, they will be liberated from obstructors,

demons, and the like. One should pour it over their head along with their clothing. At the time of pouring, the one who recites the dhāraṇī and the one who receives the recitation both have their outer and inner bodies purified.

One should recite with single-pointed mind, thinking that one will be freed from spirits and demonic afflictions. The wet clothing should be discarded as a means of casting away defilement. One then puts on fresh white clothing, adorns the body with incense, flowers, and the like, and by reciting the dhāraṇī a single time the body is protected. One should also recite the auspicious verses.

Around the circumference of that maṇḍala, the eight World-Protectors are each invoked by name, and offerings are made to them. Then one makes the aspiration: "May whatever I am now accomplishing be fulfilled." One makes offerings with a single fivefold offering, and to the common spirits one gives a generous torma offering.

The self-protection and the setting of boundaries are likewise to be performed properly using this same Amogha-pāśa dhāraṇī. This practice is appropriate to perform on the eighth day of the lunar month.

Not only does this rite liberate those who are afflicted by obstructors and the rest, as described above, but if it is performed for an ordinary person it will also render them thereafter impervious to obstructors and magical attack, prevent them from being struck by contagious illness, and cause their glory to be great and all their wishes to be fulfilled.

Among the five precious substances: gold, coral, pearl, conch, and crystal. Among the five medicines: siṃha, vyāghrī, girikarṇī, saha, and sahadewa. Among the five grains: barley, rice, sesame, wheat, and black lentil.

This concludes the dhāraṇī called the Heart of the Noble Amogha-pāśa.

Oṃ ye dharmā hetuprabhavā hetun teṣāṃ tathāgato hyavadat, teṣāṃ ca yo nirodha evaṃ vādī mahāśramaṇaḥ svāhā.

Oṃ supraṭiṣṭha vajrāye svāhā.

Maṅgalaṃ. Śubhaṃ.

Translator's Notes

- "The son of Śāradvatī" refers to the arhat Śāriputra, whose epithet "great wisdom" and patronymic are both invoked here, which is consistent with the standard liturgical homage sections of dhāraṇī texts of this type.

"Mahāpaśupativedhadhara" literally means "bearer of the piercing of the Great Lord of Beasts," an epithet associated with Śiva incorporated into the dhāraṇī's divine retinue invocation. The dhāraṇī addresses and subsumes a wide array of Brahmanical deities — Soma, Āditya, Yama, Varuṇa, Kubera, Brahma, Indra, Vāyu, Agni, Rudra, Sanatkumāra, and Vināyaka — as part of the mantra's protective scope, which is characteristic of this genre of Mahāyāna dhāraṇī literature.

The closing terms "indriya, bala" (sense faculties, power) appear abruptly and likely mark the beginning of a further section of the dhāraṇī that continues beyond the passage provided here.

- The phrase rendered "Amitābhasutāya" (literally "son of Amitābha") is an unusual epithet applied to Avalokiteśvara in his role as the emanation of Amitābha; the Tibetan reads འཇིག་རྟེན་འཇིག་རྟེན་འཇིག་རྟེན་ which supports this reading.

The phrase འཇིག་རྟེན་འཇིག་རྟེན་འཇིག་རྟེན་འཇིག་རྟེན་འཇིག་རྟེན་ is somewhat technical and concerns the sealing of a clay vase's neck with a strip of black leather pressed into the rim; the translation reflects the most plausible ritual reading.

- The five medicines listed — siṃha, vyāghrī, girikarṇī, saha, and sahadeva — are Sanskrit plant names transliterated into Tibetan. Their exact botanical identifications vary across traditions and are not rendered here beyond transliteration, as any further specification would go beyond what the text warrants.

The colophon formula "Om ye dharmā..." is the celebrated verse summarizing dependent origination, standard in Buddhist colophons. "Om supratīṣṭha vajrāye svāhā" is a standard consecration mantra. "Maṅgalaṃ" means "auspiciousness" and "Śubhaṃ" means "good fortune" — both are conventional closing benedictions.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.